

Paul Soteropulos

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"Full Stack Software Engineer with 3+ years architecting and building distributed systems - from a custom real-time bidding platform to a multi-vertical inventory taxonomy serving thousands of data models. Comfortable owning ambiguous requirements end-to-end: from stakeholder discovery through architecture, implementation, and mentoring teammates on engineering standards."

SKILLS

Languages TypeScript/JavaScript, Python, Go, SQL, HTML5, CSS3

Frontend React, Next.js, Redux, TailwindCSS, Vite, Socket.io, custom WebSocket/SSE clients

Backend Django, Django REST Framework, Go (gorilla/mux), Express, Flask, Node.js

AI/Agentic Agentic AI workflows (Claude Code), LLM API integration (OpenAI)

Data/Infra PostgreSQL (incl. PostGIS, pgbouncer), MongoDB, Redis, Docker, Docker Compose, Nginx, ELK Stack, AWS (EC2, S3), Terraform, Cloudflare Tunnels

Quality/Process ESLint, Prettier, ruff, pytest, Vitest, pre-commit hooks, GitHub Actions CI/CD, Jira, Agile/Scrum

Also familiar with Java, C#, ASP.NET, Spring Boot/MVC

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Jeff Martin Auctioneers, Full Stack Software Engineer

Apr 2024 – Jul 2026

Built a two-sided auction ecosystem (14-service Go/Django/Next.js microservices backend) spanning an internal staff operations platform - auction, inventory, invoicing, locations, and staff/customer user management - and a customer-facing portal for account management, invoicing, and online bidding, plus a standalone bidder-registration kiosk, as one of the founding engineers on a 4-person team.

Work GitHub (private org repos): github.com/ai-psoteropulos

- Designed and built a custom WebSocket/SSE client library from scratch for two Next.js applications after determining no maintained Socket.io implementation existed for Go - implemented JWT-aware reconnection with proactive token refresh, exponential backoff, and a dynamic transport-selection layer that gated sensitive bid data from anonymous users while reducing connection overhead for non-authenticated traffic.
- Co-designed a ~35-message real-time bidding protocol with a backend engineer, driving requirements for a custom Go connection hub while independently owning the entire client-side implementation across both frontends; later led a modularization refactor to improve maintainability and onboarding for new engineers.
- Led requirements-gathering directly with company leadership to extract a viable product-category taxonomy for a multi-vertical marketplace (heavy equipment through general merchandise) from a client with no existing structure and frequently-changing requirements; designed a governance model where attribute-level edits were self-service for business staff while structural category changes routed through engineering.
- Built code-generation tooling that produces Django models - with class inheritance mirroring the category hierarchy - DRF serializers, and a versioned JSON attribute-schema system supporting attribute inheritance with per-category overrides and exclusions, generated directly from a category-tree definition; avoided hand-maintenance of 1,900+ category-specific classes as the taxonomy repeatedly changed during discovery.
- Spearheaded both the linting/formatting stack (ruff, pre-commit hooks) and the automated testing stack (pytest, pytest-django, factory_boy) for Django services, replacing years-old, partially-bypassed setups; mentored a backend engineer who independently replicated both across two additional services within two weeks.
- Spearheaded ESLint, Prettier, and Husky-managed pre-commit rollout across both Next.js frontends, and collaborated with a frontend engineer on building out Vitest test coverage.
- Owned the REST API integration layer connecting the primary Next.js frontend to the backend microservices - authentication context and token handling, inventory CRUD service modules, and item creation/edit/view workflows.
- Built the client application for a bidder-registration kiosk from zero as a technical proof-of-concept during the company's first weeks, implementing a webcam-based photo-capture flow with in-browser face detection (TensorFlow.js) and a QR-code pre-registration/check-in flow.
- Integrated a third-party WebRTC live-streaming service (Dolby.io/Millicast) into the live-auction frontend, building the video player embedding, stream controls, and stats UI, and maintaining the integration through upstream API changes.
- Authored and organized the majority of the team's 900+ Jira tickets and directed sprint scope with teammates, gathering requirements directly from company ownership, the VP of Technology, IT leadership, and auction-floor managers - including on-site observation at live auctions and hands-on equipment-yard inventory intake to ground requirements in real operational workflows - without a dedicated product owner on the team.
- Led a multi-repo dependency-remediation effort across two Next.js frontends, auditing and upgrading packages by risk tier and upgrading core tooling (ESLint).

- Hunt Safe Technologies LLC**, Full Stack Software Engineer (Part-Time) **Aug 2025 – Present**
Part-time full-stack contributor to HuntSync, a hunting-club safety and management platform - applying full-stack and systems-architecture experience from Jeff Martin Auctioneers to a smaller, faster-moving codebase.
- Debugged and iterated on map-based frontend features, helped shape backend data structures, and collaborated on the API layer connecting them.
- Sojourn Creations LLC**, Full Stack Developer **May 2023 – Oct 2025**
Co-founded a startup building Aisop, an AI-driven multiplayer choose-your-own-adventure game (Next.js, Django, OpenAI API, custom Node.js/TypeScript socket server); dissolved 2025.
- Contributed to a Node.js/TypeScript real-time socket server powering multiplayer game sessions, including a major architectural refactor of the connection/session layer, alongside full-stack feature work integrating OpenAI's API to drive AI Dungeon Master narration.
 - Set up multi-environment DevOps tooling - Docker Compose, encrypted secret management, and Terraform-provisioned AWS infrastructure - across development, staging, and production.
- Salish Marine Charters**, Lead Full Stack Developer **Apr 2023 – May 2024**
- Independently designed and built a full-stack invoicing and dispatch management application (React, Node.js, MongoDB) for a marine charter/towing business as pro bono contract work, deployed to a staging environment for client testing.
- Coding Dojo (Colorado Technical University)**, Full Stack Developer and Instruction Team **Mar 2023 – Jan 2024**
- Balanced a developer role with a faculty instructor role, teaching full-stack fundamentals across JS, Python, Java, and C# stacks.
- Currently**
- Self-hosting several personal projects on custom home infrastructure (Docker Compose, Cloudflare Tunnels, VLAN network segmentation).

TECHNICAL PROJECTS

- Portfolio**, Creator/Developer **2026**
- Personal portfolio site (psoteropulos.com) built with React/TypeScript/Vite, with full CI/CD (GitHub Actions build, GHCR image push, self-hosted deploy runner) and an automated pipeline that syncs the latest resume PDF from a separate private repo into the live site on every update.
- moodRING**, Creator, Designer, Developer **2022**
- Built a music-based social app (moodring.net) with Spotify Web/Embed API integration, JWT auth, and custom image-filter-based UI components; designed and deployed independently (AWS EC2).
- CookBook**, Backend Developer **2022**
- Built the backend (Express, MongoDB, Mongoose) for a group recipe-collection app; led debugging efforts and JWT-based auth/session handling.

EDUCATION

- Coding Dojo (Colorado Technical University)**, Full-Stack Web Development Cert (Faculty) **Apr 2023 – Jan 2024**
- Faculty Instructor Mastery in Fullstack JS, Python, Java, and C#
 - Perfect scores on all exams; Highest level of achievement available (Black Belt)
- Coding Dojo**, Full-Stack Web Development Certificate (Student) | Remote Online **Jul 2022 – Dec 2022**
- Immersive Full-Stack Developer Training Program in Web Fundamentals, Python, and MERN
 - Perfect scores on all exams; Highest level of achievement available (Black Belt)
- University of Louisiana Lafayette**, Sophomore, Mechanical Engineering Major, Math Minor **Aug 2004 – Mar 2007**
- Relevant Coursework: Heavy emphasis on physics, mathematics, logic, and problem solving

ADDITIONAL EXPERIENCE

- Fox Press, Mandeville, LA**, Distributions Director **Jul 2020 – Jun 2022**
- Managed a team of 6 to maintain time-sensitive shipping/receiving workflows and inventory accuracy.
 - Reduced outbound shipping damage claims by 75% through improved packing/QA standards.
- Slama Construction / Solar Supply**, Trim Carpentry & HVAC Distribution **Nov 2016 – Jul 2020**
- Pontchartrain Pharmacy / Brand Direct Health Pharmacy**, Certified Pharmacy Technician **2008 – 2016**
- PTCB-certified and Louisiana Board of Pharmacy (LABP) licensed pharmacy technician, both active and in good standing since December 2008.

Extended job history and references available upon request.